

If the Forms are Identical, Why Shouldn't the Meaning Be? The Case of Turkish Conditional Markers

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I. The conditional morpheme(s)

The conditional morpheme in Turkish comes in two varieties: -sA (and -(y)sA) for X-marked and O-marked conditionals respectively [1,2]. (Capitals denote harmonizing vowels).

- (1) Can gel-ir-se Meryem de gel-ir.
John come-aor-SA Mary add come-aor
'If John comes, Mary will come too.' **O-mark**
- (2) Can gel-se Meryem de gel-ir.
John come-SA Mary add come-aor
'If John came, Mary would come too.' **X-mark**

Context 1: Mary is waiting to decide whether to go to school today. John texted her earlier saying he might come. If he does, she wants to go with him. If not, she'll stay home. She's still unsure.

(1) Ok (2) infelicitous

Context 2: John is usually too lazy to come to school these days, and today is no exception, he's probably at home sleeping. Mary dislikes going to school unless John is there, but since he's unlikely to come, she's staying home too.

(1) infelicitous (2) Ok

II. Previous Analyses

- Treats -sA and -(y)sA as two separate morphemes for subjunctive and indicative respectively. [1,2]
 - Exclusivity of aorist explained by structural reasons, -(y)sA being a copular clitic along with the past markers -(y)DI and -(y)mİş [1]
- (3) Can gel-ir-se Meryem gel-me-yecek
John come-aor-cop-SA Mary come-neg-fut
'If John comes, Mary will not come.'
- The presuppositional analysis differentiates between the two morphemes by assuming that -sA form comes with an extra presupposition [2,3]:
 - Presupp of -sA: p is more likely false than true for speaker

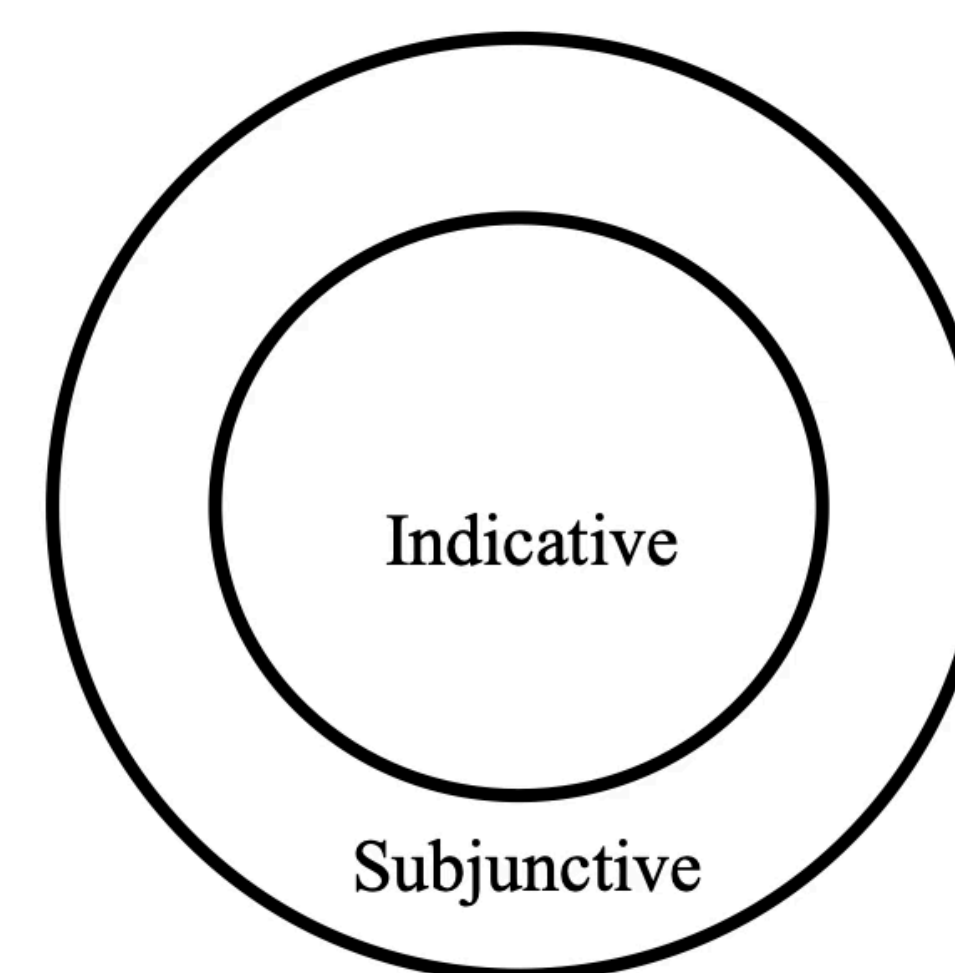
Goal:

To unify the two conditional morphemes under a single lexical entry and explain the O vs X-mark difference with other elements that appear along.

III. Antipresupposition and indicative conditionals

- Indicative conditionals have been analyzed as being presuppositionally heavier than their subjunctive counterparts [5,6]
- This explains the domain widening effect of subjunctives with indicatives narrowing the domain.
- Presuppositions of Indicative: $\Diamond \text{epis}_s p$
- Presuppositions of Subjunctive: $\emptyset$

- i. $\sim B_s[\Diamond \text{epis}_s p]$ OR $\sim B_s[\text{Auth}[\Diamond \text{epis}_s p]]$
ii. $\sim B_s[\Diamond \text{epis}_s p]$ (from (i) and Authority)
iii. $B_s[\sim \Diamond \text{epis}_s p]$ (from (ii) and Competence)
iv. $\sim \Diamond \text{epis}_s p$ (from (iii) and Reliability)



- When the speaker utters the Subjunctive form, the speaker is not in a position to comment on the nearest worlds covered by Indicative conditional.

IV. Outlook

- Applying the antipresupposition analysis to Turkish conditionals by assuming that the aorist morpheme comes with a epistemic possibility presupposition.
- Aorist presupposition: p is epistemically possible for s
- This unifies the two morphemes and delegates the difference between subjunctive and indicative conditionals to the morphemes that appear along with -sA
- Other morphemes that appear with indicatives like the progressive and the future morpheme could also be said to carry the same presupposition
- For pragmatic competition, both structures should be equally complex [7], so this analysis requires subjunctive cases to come with a phonologically null subjunctive morpheme.
- The structural analysis cannot explain the appearance of copula-like /y/ sound in other hiatus environments like (3)

	Analysis	Ambiguity
Goksel & Kerslake	Structural difference	Ambiguity wrt. -sA
Soykan	Presuppositional Difference	Ambiguity wrt. -sA
Antipresupposition	Presuppositional difference with Aorist	No ambiguity